Maharaja. Moreover, in a feat of useful amnesia in tracing the lineage of the clan, the Kachhwahas are shown as descending directly from Prithviraj Kachhwaha to Bharmal Kachhwaha, effacing all the troublesome contending factions and cousins in between.

Raja Man Singh did not restrict his patronage of architecture to his watan jagir. He built temples on a far larger scale, covering a much wider geographical range than any other pre-modern patron in India, and this was a testament not only to the wealth he commanded as a Mughal mansabdar but also to the ambition he rightly claimed as a highly successful commander and as the Padshah's cherished farzand. Raja Man Singh was governor of Bihar from 1587 to 1594 during which time he established Mughal power firmly in the region. Most of his temples were built in Bihar —in Rohtas, Patna, Baikatpur, and Manpur, on the outskirts of Bodh Gaya. For Raja Man Singh the celebration of his status as a Hindu raja did not clash in any way with his identity as Mughal mansabdar. Indeed, the two seemed to overlap and intertwine in such a way that imperial visibility was increased even as the raja used Hindu symbolism. Raja Man Singh performed an elaborate and ostentatious shraddha at Gaya for forty-five days following his father's death, much longer than the stipulated period of sixteen days. He then built a town, now largely destroyed, on the opposite bank of the river from Gaya called Manpur and began work on the Govind Deva temple. In addition to Hindu temples, the raja built mosques in Lahore and at Rajmahal, and maintained the shrine of a Sufi saint in Hajipura.

Raja Man Singh also built structures commemorating important victories in his capacity as Mughal subedar, the most significant of which were his buildings at Rohtas Fort in Bihar. This fort, well-situated and strategically important, was considered essential in controlling Bihar, Bengal, and Orissa. On the highest spot of the hill was a temple dedicated to the area's legendary patron, Rohitsava. Raja Man Singh had a smaller structure built at the foot of the Rohitsava temple that looks remarkably like the tomb of Salim Chishti at Fatehpur Sikri. This temple resembling the tomb of a Sufi saint in the distant east, is a fascinating co-opting of a local deity using multiple and complex symbols.

In the fort itself, Raja Man Singh built an enormous palace complex, based loosely on the plan of Fatehpur Sikri, which was the largest non-imperial palace built in the entire Mughal Empire. This was clearly not meant as a private residence alone as it had administrative sections, such as